

www.orletonvillage.co.uk

ORLETON VILLAGE MAGAZINE



May 2026

How to be included in Orleton Village Magazine

This magazine will be published on the first day of each month on the Village Website:

www.orletonvillage.co.uk.

Notification of publication, together with a link, will be given on Nextdoor and Orleton Village Chat (Facebook)

Articles of general interest, club or association reports and advertisements for community events may be included without charge. Commercial advertisements are charged, dependent on size. (Rates available on request from:

orletonmagazine@gmail.com)

Small private sale advertisements may be accepted without charge if space allows

All content is accepted at the discretion of the editorial team. Articles that are disrespectful or prejudicial will not be accepted.

Copy should be submitted as Word or PDF files. If hard copy is submitted there may be a charge for scanning and input.

All copy must be accompanied by the name, address and telephone number of the author, although this will not be included unless incorporated into the article.

Articles for publication should be emailed to:

orletonmagazine@gmail.com by the 25th of the month prior to desired publication

Orleton Village Hall

Ideal venue for family events, parties, weddings, concerts, dances, training courses, drama performance, exhibitions, classes and craft fairs.

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Editorial

We live in a very unusual village in that it is blessed with many facilities that most villages do not have:

- the village is situated off a main road so there is little through traffic, apart from the tractors!
- we have a regular bus service;
- a doctor's surgery;
- a well-stocked village shop;
- a post office Mon -Sat
- a large village hall
- an exceptional recreation ground
- church and chapel
- two very popular pubs
- a number of very attractive and historic houses

All of the above contribute to making this a very desirable location, for example, the motorhome club make repeat visits. Brownies from both Ludlow, Hereford and elsewhere, use the village hall for their sleepovers. (You may have noticed painted pebbles left around the village as a thank you from Burghill Brownies)

However, these blessings do have a downside. To meet the Government Housing Targets Hereford Council previously allocated based on a percentage where even the smallest hamlet, without any facilities, had to accept a couple of new dwellings, whilst we had Captain's Meadow.

In the next plan there will not be homes allocated to areas without services. This means that an increased burden will have to be carried by those areas that boast at least a shop, and a bus service.

A village as well served as Orleton is likely to attract a target that is twice that of a Captain's Meadow. As this will be mandatory it will be as futile to mount objections to this target as it was to the last development.

What needs to be done is to seek to ensure that developments when they come are located in places where they detract least from the unique character of the Village and that their design is sympathetic to our rural location.



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Orleton and District
Gardening Club

Scent in the garden



A talk by

Timothy Walker

Tuesday 26th May 7.30pm for 8pm start
Orleton Village Hall

**Non-members welcome at £2.50 per person
Complimentary tea/coffee and biscuits**

Membership just £15.00 per year

Come along to the meeting or see www.oreltongardeningclub.co.uk



Orleton and District
Gardening Club



PLANT SALE

Sunday May 17th 2026

Orleton Village Hall

10.30 am until sold out

**Annuals and Perennials Tomato plants
Houseplants**

Bedding plants Shrubs Herbs Vegetables Fruit

Fruit and vegetable produce

**Sharpening service for garden tools, knives,
scissors etc**

Bacon rolls, cakes, tea and coffee

FREE ADMISSION – ALL WELCOME

Orleton Evergreens



Our 2026 programme is well under way:

The next few months see us out and about:

May 28th Spring Lunch

June 25th Seaside Outing to Weston Super Mare £20 (£22 non members)

July 30th Outing to St Fagan's Museum of History, Cardiff £26 (£28 non members), maximum 30 people

August 27th Outing to Gloucestershire & Warwickshire Steam Railway, Cheltenham £37 (£39 non members)

ALL WELCOME

Further details:

sue.a.turner@gmail.com 01584
831324

Flower Festival

St George's Church, Orleton

Saturday 6 & Sunday 7 June

11am-5pm

**Beautiful & imaginative flower displays
celebrating 100 years of TV**

**Refreshments available,
including light lunch**

Coffee Morning

Every Wednesday – Orleton Village Hall 10.30 – 12.00*

Pop along, meet your friends & make new ones too. Parents and Grandparents are welcome to join us, with toddlers. We have a small selection of toys for them to play with.

We have a good choice of freshly-baked homemade goodies including gluten & dairy free, all slices are currently only £1 each. Beverages including Fairtrade are £1 for a cuppa with a free refill.

***Please note that we do not open throughout August, and we have two weeks off during the Christmas holidays.**



- Visiting Library – last Wednesday of the month
- A relaxed informal group with no membership fees
- Foodbank box for local foodbank
- We make charitable donations to local groups



Are you a local group who would like to run a fundraising coffee morning? Please Contact our Chair Cathy Hardwick via email at cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk

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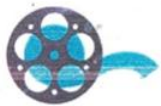


Orleton Art Group

Are you artistic or do you fancy trying your hand at painting and drawing? If so come and join us. We meet Wednesday afternoons from 2.00 until 4.30pm at Yarpole Village Hall.

For more information, please email Larry Turner, laurencepturner@gmail.com or Geoff Trotter, geoffrey.a.trotter@gmail.com

Or telephone Larry on 01584 831324



Come along to another Jukebox Evening

With music from some great films

Saturday 16th May @ 7-00pm

St George's Church, Orleton

Wine , soft drinks and nibbles

Entry is free with donations helping with the work of
The St George's Community Association



Orleton WI

Our April meeting began with the usual business: £54 subs are now due (still less than £5 per meeting), visitors £5;

We raised an incredible £206 at the recent coffee morning and bring & buy.

There is to be a flower festival at St George's Church on 6th/7th June to which we have been invited to partake.

The HFWI Archivist, Tessa Lovell's talk, 'Looking After Our Archives' was both interesting and informative; Orleton WI has been in existence for 89 years, so there are a number of documents and newspaper articles

that tell our story and indeed, that of other Herefordshire WI's, some of these are stored in the archives at HARC (Hereford Archive & Records Centre) on the Rotherwas Industrial Estate, some at WI House, others in member's homes - it is important that WI's keep a track of where their archives are as records can disappear! We were urged to date and label photographs and store items correctly to avoid damage; the recommendation is to use flat cardboard boxes (not plastic) which are acid free and not stored on the floor, to avoid metal paper clips, string, plastic, sticky tape and elastic bands as these deteriorate over time; textiles should be rolled with acid free paper.



Our WI tablecloth is a wonderful work of art, created by four members 23 years ago; it depicts Orleton Shop & Post Office, St George's Church and The Boot together with alder leaves, catkins and fruits.

Two of the original team continue to be members today. We are planning to make a new banner, along similar

lines, for our 90th anniversary next year.

The next WI meeting is on Monday 13th May at 7:30pm, the speaker will be Andreea from 'The Small Bakery' - Orleton's very own focaccia baker! Visitors welcome.

HOME CLEANING SERVICE

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dusting, bathrooms, toilets, kitchen.
Deep cleaning- fridge, kitchen cupboards,
drawers, inside windows

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- Deep Cleaning
- Office Cleaning

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Orleton Coffee Morning needs you!

Orleton holds a weekly coffee morning at our village hall on a **Wednesday morning at 10.30am–12 noon.**

We offer homemade bakes, hot drinks, and a friendly informal place to meet and chat.

We would love to welcome a few more folk onto our team of helpers.

Do you have a favourite bake you may like to share with us?

Enjoy meeting and greeting folk, and maybe you would like to help at a session on an occasional basis?

WE WOULD LOVE TO HEAR FROM YOU!

*Please contact our Chair Cathy Hardwick via email at:
cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk*

Orleton Craft Group



We meet on the first and third Thursday afternoons in Orleton Village Small Hall, £4 per session.

Our Crafternoons run from 1:30 to 4:30, bring along whatever you are working on, enjoy friendship, chat, tea and cake!

Orleton Village **SUMMER FETE** **SUNDAY 5th JULY** **SAVE THE DATE**



Can you help us?

We need Volunteers to run stalls
and manage parking

email: orletonhandmade@gmail.com

And donations of second hand goods (no clothing)



RAISED BED VEGETABLE GARDENING

On 31st March we welcomed Marion Stainton, a horticulturist with an interest in sustainable, environmentally friendly gardening. She has been involved in planning domestic, commercial and community projects.

Vegetables have been grown in raised beds since medieval times. In monastery gardens the beds were edged with wattle fences. Victorian bedding schemes were planted on raised beds but it was not until the 1970s that these became fully enclosed. Timber is ideal, modern treatments will not harm plants but railway sleepers should be avoided because of the creosote content.

Marion advocates the no-dig method. Double digging can result in a pan, it damages soil mycorrhiza and brings weed seeds to the surface. Mulching enriches the soil and the organic matter acts as a sponge. A healthy soil begets healthy plants and they have been found to grow better in a firmer soil. The optimum width of a bed is 1.5m to allow access from either side. Pathways should be wide enough to accommodate a wheelbarrow, approximately 0.5m.

Crop rotation is advised to prevent the build up of pests and diseases and a minimum of three beds is required. Potatoes make a good first crop followed perhaps by brassicas and then legumes. Harvesting times should be checked as often a second crop can be grown, salad crops may be grown alongside brassicas for example as they will be ready before the latter have

matured. Vigilance is needed to spot pests and diseases. Brassicas can be grown in a cage and salads and carrots do well under fleece draped over wire hoops. Homemade cardboard collars may be used around strawberry plants.

Marion accompanied her informative talk with slides of her enviably well-ordered vegetable garden and provided leaflets detailing advice on crop rotation.

Ghislaine Arundale

On Sunday 17th May we hold our **Annual Plant Sale** at Orleton Village Hall.

Opens 10.30. Refreshments tea and coffee, sausage and bacon rolls and cakes. A big variety of annuals & perennials will be for sale. Sharpening service for tools.

On Tuesday 26th May Timothy Walker will present a talk entitled **Scent in The Garden**

The talk is based on an award winning Chelsea Flower Show garden and explores types of plants, how to make your garden more fragrant and why plants are scented.

At Orleton Village Hall. Doors open 7.15pm for 8pm start. Non-members welcome at £2.50 per person which includes tea or coffee. Annual Membership £15.00

www.orletongardeningclub.co.uk

TABLE TOP SALE!

at Orleton Village Hall, SY8 4HW

Sunday, June 14th, 2026

10.00am - 1.00pm



£10 per table,
Maximum 2 tables per booking

Contact: bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk

★ ★ ★ or 01568 780583 ★ ★ ★

Orleton Parish Council

The Highway Flood Alleviation Scheme

At the Parish Council meeting held on 24 April, Cllr Lane and Ward Cllr Dan Hurcomb presented the final designs for the scheme to capture surface water on the B4361 and redirect it around the village. Further details of the scheme, including a copy of the PowerPoint presentation, are on the Parish Council website, <https://orleton-pc.gov.uk/>. The Natural Flood Management measures above the B4361 are also at an advanced stage and work is due to commence on overspill ponds in September, led by the Severn Rivers Trust. Meanwhile the project timetable for the removal of the culvert immediately above the B4361 has been delivered to the Parish Council for review.

Land Drainage Volunteers

The Parish Council has approved the use of hedge-cutters and strimmers by volunteers clearing Brimfield Brook. We must thank Cllr Jones for his work in drafting the necessary Risk Management and Method Statements to underpin this work. The first task undertaken following this decision was the clearance of sediment around the balancing pond outlet in Brimfield Brook adjacent to Captain's Meadow. We thank Shropshire Homes for consenting to this work. The culvert under Millbrook Way bridge was also dredged and the entrances cleared of debris.

Parish Meeting

The annual Parish Meeting will be held on Wednesday, 13 May at 7pm at the Village Hall. The guest speaker will be Jacob Laughran of the Severn Rivers Trust who will talk about their work promoting efforts to increase flood resilience through natural land management and in particular their work above Orleton where they are currently working with landowners. The meeting will also provide the opportunity for residents to raise any matter of general concern to the community.

The precept

At our November meeting, the Parish Council voted to increase the Parish Precept by 2.5% for the 2026-27 fiscal year, significantly below the current rate of inflation. When calculated for the current number of properties in the parish, this worked out to a 1% increase per household, as shown on the council tax statements sent out last month.

Dog Waste

Thank you to everyone who is disposing of dog waste in the appropriate bins around the parish. We have been told, however, that dog waste is being left in the verges around Orleton Rise and presenting a problem for their groundsmen. There is no excuse for anyone to not pick up after their dogs, especially as there is a dog waste bin on Green Lane just south of the caravan park's entrance. This bin is emptied by the team at Orleton Rise for everyone's convenience and as part of their commitment to our community, for which the Parish Council is greatly appreciative. The Parish Council would also like to remind people that non-dog-waste rubbish should not be put in the dog waste bins. This results in there being less space for dog waste which is then left on the ground, creating an unsightly mess and a health hazard. However, it is possible to place dog waste in the general waste bins.

Next Meeting

The next meeting of Parish Council will be on Thursday, 21 May in Orleton Village Hall at 6pm. The meeting will start with the Annual Meeting of the Parish Council, and the Ordinary Meeting will follow. Members of the public are encouraged to attend.

To contact the Clerk or any of your Parish Councillors, please e-mail clerk@orleton-pc.gov.uk
Stacy Perry, Clerk, Orleton Parish Council

Book Sale



You are warmly invited to a
Book sale, tea/coffee, cake and chat
Saturday 23rd May
St George's Church
10am-midday



ORLETON
2027
CALENDAR

With the work of local
photographers
chosen by a public vote

2027 CALENDAR

The theme is

“A natural place to be”

The closing date for
submission of your
photos will be

3rd July 2026

Photographers,
We will need your
images for the
2027 Calendar ,
including Spring
shots , so get
snapping now.

Mortimer Medical Practice – Patient Participation Group

Total Triage (Anima)

The Practice is pleased to announce that Anima requests can now be made on the NHS App, and patients are urged to access Anima online wherever possible. Patients ringing in to make appointments can cause longer waits (up to 15 minutes) for patients requiring other services. Consequently, the following measures are aimed at helping patients make full use of Anima:

1. For patients who do not have online access at home, there are now iPads in each of the three surgeries which patients can use to complete the Anima forms in the surgeries.
2. A number of follow up Anima workshops will now be held with patients in May/June.
3. Any emails received by Reception will be returned to sender with a link to Anima.

Practice News

Please be aware that there are limited appointments available for venepuncture clinics (blood tests) due to staff sickness. Charlotte Goodwin has agreed to come back until the end of April to help alleviate this problem.

Spring Booster Covid Clinics (for those who are eligible) are scheduled for the Kingsland surgery on Saturday, April 25, and at the Leintwardine and Orleton surgeries on Saturday, May 9. Clinic timings are still to be confirmed and will be publicised in due course.

Any patients needing holiday vaccinations are advised that, due to demand, the Practice requires at least 6 weeks' advance notice. The first step is to complete the appropriate form (available from all surgeries) with destination and duration of the holiday. This allows the nurse to assess the vaccines needed and if they have to be ordered. The nurse/receptionist will then contact you to arrange a suitable time for an appointment. The Practice advises that it is no longer able to give the Yellow Fever vaccine as it is not a registered centre.

Patients have asked whether increased funding will be made available for the Practice as a result of new houses being built in Leintwardine. Unfortunately, there will be no new funding.

Finally, Dr Paul Haverty is covering as a locum GP at the moment.

Queenswood Country Park – Park Run

Mortimer Medical Practice is pleased to support the Queenswood Country Park – Park Run, a five kilometre run or walk starting at 9am every Saturday at Queenswood, Dinmore Hill, Leominster. You can register to join at www.parkrun.org.uk. A parking charge applies.

The next PPG meeting is on Wednesday, June 17, 2026.

If you have any issues or concerns you wish to raise, contact Kate Best (kate.mortimerppg@gmail.com), Sue Plant on 01584 831105 (sue.mortimerppg@gmail.com) or Simon Davies (simon.mortimerppg@gmail.com).



TUESDAY 12TH MAY AT 8.00PM AT THE BOOT INN

Hosted by

Dan Hurecomb

TEAMS OF UP TO 6 PEOPLE ENTRY £2 PLUS RAFFLE

Please ring ahead to book your table

- Made things that you wish to sell?
- Grown plants that you have too many of?
- Spring cleaning or downsizing – need to dispose of things too good to throw away?
- Children's toys or games that they have out-grown?
- Sports equipment that you no longer use?
- Unwanted Christmas or birthday gifts?
- Bored with things- need to change your décor?

All of these are good reasons to book a table at the Orleton Village Hall Table Top Sale.

The Sale will be held on Sunday 14th June, and a table will only cost £10.

Based on the demand at the previous sale we regret that we must restrict each seller to a maximum of two tables.

Only twenty two tables will be available.

Further details will be published nearer the event, but a seller may reserve a table(s) now, without cost, by simply sending their name and contact details to: bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk

Goods on sale must be capable of table top display (or stored under the table). The Village Hall Management regrets that to reasons of health and safety large items that take up floor space can not be accepted.

May & June Family Services

All in St George's Church

Sunday 10th May

(includes baptism)

Sunday 24th May

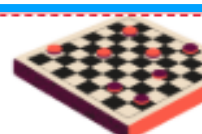
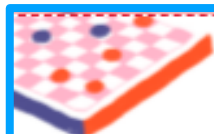
(drama focused)

Sunday 14th June

(craft focused)

Sunday 28th June

(drama focused)



PIZZA AND GAMES

FRIDAY 1 MAY 6-8PM

ST GEORGE'S CHURCH

FRIDAY 5 JUNE 6-8PM

VENUE TBC

For all those who enjoy traditional family games, card games, newer strategy games, or all three

Orleton Footpath Maintenance Volunteers OFMV

We've had a busy couple of months despite the earlier wet weather

We had a very muddy Saturday in January installing a metal pedestrian gate on the proposed Comberton Trail ...we even got a 4wd stuck and despite Herculean efforts by the team we had to have a tractor pull out from Mikey Hyde ...thank you Mikey

We got the gate installed and a ditch bridge repaired...and some very muddy people and clothes to wash



In February we installed two more self-closing galvanised pedestrian gates in Jimmy Morgan's fields which are on the Herefordshire Trail as it passes through Orleton, opening up a circular walk from the Rec woods around the fields behind and back through these 'new' gates up towards the church, now with no stiles to climb over

End February/early March saw us on the Apperley Recreation Ground volunteering for ORA rehanging the pedestrian gate next to the children's play area, repairing the rail fencing, and installing two wider galvanised pedestrian gates:

- * to enable easier access for child buggies, mobility scooters, wheelchairs, etc

- * one by the car park, the other by the electricity substation off Mortimer Drive

As our footpath maintenance work area now covers north Herefordshire we removed a rotted stile in Little Hereford We replaced this with a galvanised kissing gate and a new footpath marker fingerpost - tree roots were challenging on this job



Other stuff we've got involved with are:

A recce to repair steps up the steep bank on the Mortimer Trail at Aymestrey, and also recce-ing the innovative bridge design recently installed by the Weobley Footpath Team volunteers for £3000 instead of £30,000 if done by contractors. Also sorted was hazardous barbed wire next to footpath/footbridge on the Bonfire field in Orleton;

Progression of Grant funding and ongoing supply of gates for the Comberton Trail; and we're also pleased to say we've been successful in a grant application for improvements to our Orleton section of the Herefordshire Trail

Looking forward -...less mud, more sunshine, installing a new ditch bridge + handrail + a galvanised pedestrian gate on Herefordshire Trail towards Richards Castle, plus very likely installing more gates on the proposed Comberton Trail

Many many thanks to our enthusiastic volunteers who include Alex, Dave, Mike, Merle, Tony, Mark, Paul, Richard, ...always fun always tea 'n biscuits

Congratulations to Mark and Mike for both just becoming Orleton Parish Councillors ...they both volunteer with us in OFMV ..and also with Orleton Land Drainage Volunteers...thanks guys from our Orleton community

If anyone fancies mucking in please get in touch

Contact: Martin Bradford 01568 780151



Choose Your Fillings

(All fillings can be mixed & matched)



● Grated Mature Cheddar



● Baked Beans

● Homemade Coleslaw



● Chilli Con Carne



● Chicken Curry



£6.50 EACH

Includes any combination of fillings

Janet's Jacket Potatoes
will be visiting Orleton Village Hall Car Park on
from 5.30 until 7.30 pm.
Check Facebook for dates
Select on the night or pre-order on the Facebook site

Orleton Charity Quiz Nights

May 12th	Boot Inn	October 13th	Boot Inn
June 9th	Village Hall	November 16th	Village Hall
September 8th	Maidenhead	December 8th	Maidenhead

All proceeds go to support local organisations in Orleton Village or recognised National Charities.

Special Event: John Robbins Memorial Quiz at Orleton Village Hall on a Saturday evening. Watch for the date!

**Teams of up to six members. 7.30 for a 8.00pm start
Pre-booking of tables at:
the Boot (01568 780228) and the Maidenhead (01584 831686)**

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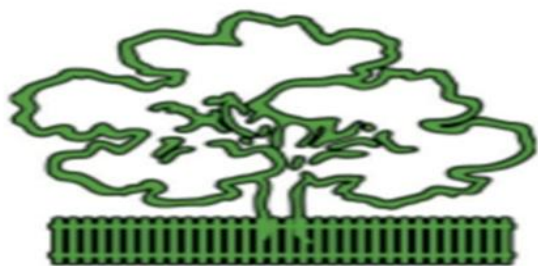
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Orleton and District
Gardening Club

Start preparing NOW for the
45th ANNUAL SHOW
on Saturday 15th August at



Orleton Village Hall



OPEN CLASSES - Anyone can enter

Including: **HEAVIEST MARROW COMPETITION - START SOWING NOW!**

Who can ferment the best cider? Challenge your friends and neighbours.

OTHER OPEN CLASSES

Alcohol-based Cordial; Heaviest Potato; Longest Runner Bean; Most Amusing shaped Vegetable or Fruit **JUST 10p PER ENTRY**

Save the Date - Saturday 15th August - staging 10 - 11.30 am, viewing 1.30 - 3.30pm. For more details and show rules see **SHOW SCHEDULE at www.orletongardeningclub.co.uk**



What do you think about when you shop? Do you ever stop to think about the people who have produced the foods you are placing into your basket and how far the foods may have travelled and from which countries?

Items concerned include tea, coffee, cocoa, chocolate, sugar, bananas and some cotton goods, to name but a few of the most well-known ones.

Most of the people who produce these foods don't get a fair price and a fair deal; but by supporting foods labelled with the Fairtrade mark you will be helping in a very big way.

What difference does choosing Fairtrade make? Farmers and workers are guaranteed the Fairtrade minimum price for their produce. It means they are more likely to be able to cover their household costs like education, food and healthcare

Fairtrade is all about making sure the people who grow or make the things we buy get a fair price for what they do. Look out for the logo when you shop. Small changes can make a big difference.



Report from your County Councillor

Dan Hurcomb

April has gone quickly and a combination of the recent good weather and the garden fully waking up has it feeling like summer is just around the corner. I was pleased to be able to attend the annual Orleton St George's Festival on Saturday 26th April. It was lovely to see the event so well supported by the village and I would like to thank those responsible for ensuring it continues year on year.

Between the 13th – 24th April, we had the Ashley Moor road works and whilst I am pleased these are now complete (the junction definitely feels much safer now), it is fair to say they brought significant disruption to Orleton at peak times. Whilst the initial signage was inadequate, following my request, Herefordshire Council did improve it with the addition of a variety of "No Access for HGV", "Road Closed Ahead" and "Slow" signs at strategic locations. These signs improved matters but it was disheartening to see just how many HGVs continued on through the village without paying any attention to them. I will be following up with Highways to ensure lessons are learned for the future and to see what can be done to improve the situation outside of Orleton School at peak times.

On Friday 24th August I attended the Orleton Parish Council meeting to present an update on the current flood attenuation proposals. The meeting was well attended and details of the proposals are available on the Parish Council website. In brief, there are three limbs to the proposal – Natural Flood Management in the

upper catchment of the Brimfield Brook (to help slow the flow of water prior to Orleton), remedial works on the culvert under the B4361 at Ashley Moor (to remove the culverted section of the brook and reinstate the open channel) and improved drainage on the B4361 around the Maidenhead junction (hopefully coupled with resurfacing of the road in that location). These proposals have been worked on for the last two years by a number of parties and it feels like we are finally on the cusp of delivery.

On a final note, many residents have been in touch to report and comment on the recent "hedge works" that have been undertaken on a site adjacent to the B4362 at Comberton. These concerns have been reported to Herefordshire Council's Planning Enforcement Team (for alleged planning breaches), Herefordshire Council's Natural Environment Team (for potential offences under the Hedgrow Regulations) and West Mercia Police (for potential offences under the Wildlife and Countryside Act). Both Planning Enforcement and West Mercia Police have visited the site since these reports were made.

As always if you have any concerns, issues or would just like a chat then please do get in touch.

Dan Hurcomb
dan.hurcomb@herefordshire.gov.uk
07837726821

Orleton History Group

On 26th April, the Orleton History Group joined with the St George's Community Association, Village Hall, and Orleton Recreation Association, to celebrate St George's Day in style with Morris Dancing, Maypole Dancing, Mummers plays, fun activities, and food and drink.

A report and photos will follow in the next edition.

Our upcoming talks and events are:

Saturday 30th May, 2.30pm, St George's Church, Historic Leominster: Gisela Lehmann from Leominster History Group will use photographs to take us on a virtual tour of Leominster following the route she uses as a Leominster Heritage Guide for visitors to this historic town. She will introduce some of the characters in Leominster's history as well as showing the different architectural styles of the buildings and their stories.

Saturday 27th June, 2.30pm, St George's Church, The Poor Are Always With Us - the Parish and the Relief of Poverty. James Turtle will explore this fascinating topic: For more than 300 years the people of Orleton paid an annual Poor Rate - a tax on land and houses to relieve poverty among its parishioners. What help did they get? Who ended up in the workhouse?

July: in July, we have a break for the summer as audiences are usually low due to the summer holidays.

You can read reports on previous talks at the history group page at: www.stgeorgesorleton.org.uk (and then click on 'Orleton History Group'). You can also find, at the same web address, the reports on the research undertaken so far into the lives of the men on the Orleton War Memorial.

If you would like further information about the group, please contact Liz Mackay on e.e.mackay@gmail.com, or 07484

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	Shop	Post Office
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Sat	0830-1230	0830-1230
Sun	0830-1230	Closed

Whenever possible stock is sourced from local suppliers and below is a small selection;

- Tudge's bacon and sausages and hams (from Richard's Castle)
- Locally made cheeses, cakes and bread
- Variety of wines, beer and spirits
- Sweets, newspapers, magazines and local information
- Fresh fruit and vegetables
- Pet food
- Cards and stationery
- Amazon and Evri collection and drop-off
- Plants
- The shop also stocks all the household basics and a good range of Fairtrade and eco-friendly products.

Post office services include;

- Personal Banking
- Foreign Currency Exchange
- Pensions and Allowances and much more

Singing for Fun



Enjoy singing but want to just sing for fun? Why not join us at St George's 11am Friday mornings?

We sing old, well-known classics so no need to read music. All welcome, whether you want to hum, sing, or just listen.

Please just come along, or contact John Berry (jsberry47@gmail.com, 01568 782321) or Liz Mackay (e.e.mackay@gmail.com, or drop into Orleton shop)

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Orleton Good Neighbour Scheme

The Good Neighbour Scheme supports our community using a team of volunteers to help people who are experiencing difficulty in their own homes essentially, by just doing things that good neighbours do for each other.

Examples of how the scheme can help:

- Fetching prescriptions
- Occasional lifts to the surgery or hospital
- Shopping and running errands, such as posting a letter.
- Practical tasks around the home, such as changing a light bulb or hanging a picture

• **Contact Number 07467 535503**

Orleton Church & Chapel News

As I write this, the sun is shining, and it is a lovely day – appropriately, seeing as Easter was a wonderful celebratory time. We are very grateful to have been able to have a wide variety of Easter services – from a Palm Sunday service with a visit from a real pony, and a Good Friday drama which was very moving and really put across the events leading up to Jesus's crucifixion; to calmer more meditative services with a Maundy Thursday meal and Good Friday meditation. All capped off with an Easter celebration on Easter day itself, where our morning congregation and afternoon Family Service congregation came together for a shared service, followed by an Easter egg hunt. Thank you to everyone who helped put these services together, and who took part in them.

In May, we return to our usual pattern of services, both traditional morning services and more informal services in the afternoons, as detailed in the table below.

Social activities to look out for in May include:

- Pizza & Games evening, Friday 1st May, 6-8pm, St George's Church
- Jukebox evening, Saturday 16th May, 7pm, St George's Church
- Book sale, Saturday 23rd May, 10am-12pm, St George's Church

More detail on all these events can be found in the adverts elsewhere in the magazine.



Updates on our other activities, including an update on our Family Services, the Orleton History Group, Singing for Fun, Open the Book, food bank donations, and the 100 Club winners, can be found in our full newsletter, at: <https://stgeorgesorleton.org.uk/news/news> , and click on 'Church & Chapel News'.

May 2026 Services & Times at St George's & Chapel

All are invited to join us in the Chapel for a short time of prayer and meditation on Wednesday 13th and 27th May at 4.30pm. There is also a Prayer Workshop, also in the Chapel, on Wednesday 20th May at 7.30pm. All are welcome to all meetings.

Date	Time	Location	Service	Readings
Sunday 3rd May 5 th Sunday of Easter	9.30am	St George's	BCP Holy Communion	Acts 7.55-60 1 Peter 2.2-10 John 14.1-14
Sunday 10th May 6 th Sunday of Easter	10.30am	Chapel	Chapel Service, Ruth Downes, Holy Communion	Acts 17.22-31 1 Peter 3.13-22 John 14.15-21
	3pm	St George's	Family Service, Baptism	
Sunday 17th May Sunday after Ascension Day	11am	St George's	Common Worship Holy Communion	Acts 1.6-14 1 Peter 4.12-14; 5.6-11 John 17.1-11
Sunday 24th May Pentecost or Whit Sunday	10.30am	Chapel	Chapel Service, Nigel Gibbon	Acts 2.1-21 1 Corinthians 12.3b-13 John 20.19-23
	3pm	St George's	Family Service, drama-focused	
Sunday 31st May Trinity Sunday	10.30am	Lyington Church	Anglican Group Service	Isaiah 40.12-17, 27-31 2 Corinthians 13.11-13 Matthew 28.16-20
	10.30am	Chapel	Chapel Service, Mike Owens	

For further information about Church, Chapel, services or activities, or if you would like to get involved either socially or as a member of the congregation then please contact:
Matthew Burns (Vicar, St George's): 01568 614399,

teamvicarwest@leominsterteam.org.uk
Rev Denise Hargreaves (Methodist Minister):
01584 318628, dkah26@gmail.com, Ludlow Church
Office 01584 879233
Also, why not check out the St George's website: <https://stgeorgesorleton.org.uk>.



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Orleton Village Hall has regular weekly activities to which new members are always welcome. Contact details can be found here...

Monday's

- Orleton Toddlers** Every Monday morning 10-11:45am
Contact: Bethan 07534 726222 or Charlotte 07964 981036
- Orleton WI** 2nd Monday of the month, October to March at 2:30pm
Contact: Sue Copson susancopson934@gmail.com

Tuesday's

- Rainbows** Every Tuesday in term time 4:30-5:30pm
Contact Kaye Harrison kayemharrison@yahoo.co.uk
- Orleton Ramblers** 2nd and 4th Tuesday of month - Meet at Village Hall 9:50am, leaving at 10:00am
Contact: Jan Greatrex tandjgreatrex@gmail.com
- Gardening Club** Last Tuesday of the month 7:30-9:30pm
Contact: Monica 01568 613861 orletongc@hotmail.co.uk
- Yoga** Every Tuesday evening 6:30-7:30pm (Commences again in September)
Contact Rosie 07834 851656

Wednesday's

- Coffee Morning** Every Wednesday at 10:30am-12:00 (Closed in August)
Contact: Cathy Hardwick cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk
- Library** Last Wednesday of the month at Coffee Morning 10:30-11:45am
Contact: Sue Rogers 01584 831514
- Sequence Dancing** 3rd Wednesday of the month – 2-3pm
Contact: Amy Whitby amyelwynwhitby@gmail.com

Thursday's

- Evergreens** Last Thursday of the month – 2-4pm
Contact: Sue Turner sue.a.turner@gmail.com
- Craft Group** 1st and 3rd Thursday of each month 1:30-4:30pm (No sessions in August)
Contact Sue Turner 01584 831324 sue.a.turner@gmail.com
- Table Tennis** Every Thursday at 7:30pm
Contact: Geoff Lewin geoffnlewin@gmail.com

Orleton Village Hall is available for private bookings
Contact Barry Gandy 01568 780583 or bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk

All entries are, as far as we know, correct at the time of going to print.

Contacts

Allotments Assoc	Nick Ford		01584 875834
Art Group	Geoff Trotter	Geoffrey.a.trotter@gmail.com	
Caring for God' Little Acre	Barbara Mark		01568 780842
Church Wardens	Liz Mackay		07484 679671
	John Berry		01568 780321
Doctors			01584 831300
Evergreens	Sue Turner	sue.a.turner@gmail.com	01584 831324
Gardening Club	Nick Russel		01568 780678
Good Neighbour Scheme			07467 535503
Herefordshire Councillor	Cllr. Dan Hurcomb	dan.hurcomb@herefordshire.gov.uk	07792 882147
Land Drainage Group	David Lane		01568 78036
Orleton Footpath Maintenance Volunteers	Matin Bradford	emimart@hotmail.com	01568780151
Orleton Relief in Need	Barry Rogers		01584 831514
Orleton Junior Football Club	Mel Williams	cherry.brook@me.com	07511 920515
Orleton Toddlers	Bethan Jenkins	Bethan.l.edwards@hotmail.co.uk	07534 726222
Orleton Young Farmers Club	Bell Beaumont	orleyonyfc@hotmail.com	
Parish Council		clerk@orleton-pc.gov.uk	
Pre-School	Tara Morris		01568 780143
Primary School		admin@orleton.hereford.sch.uk	01568 780366
Primary School PTA	Nicola Goodman	nicolagoodman1989@gmail.com	
Rainbows	Carly Morgan		07788 236628
Recreation Association	Graham Shaw		01568 780783
Village Hall		bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk	01568 780583
WI	Sue Copson		01568 780956